

STRONGER TOGETHER

A Christian Marriage Counseling
Workbook for Couples

Build a Marriage That Honors God

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OUR MARRIAGE COVENANT REFLECTION

'Therefore what God has joined together, let no one separate.'

- Mark 10:9

Our wedding date: _____

Years married: _____

What drew me to my spouse initially:

His answer: _____

Her answer: _____

What I promised on our wedding day:

His answer: _____

Her answer: _____

What 'covenant' means to us as a couple:

Where are we now? (Rate 1-10):

Communication: His ____ Her ____

Intimacy: His ____ Her ____

Trust: His ____ Her ____

Spiritual connection: His ____ Her ____

Fun together: His ____ Her ____

COMMUNICATION STYLES ASSESSMENT

Understanding how you EACH communicate prevents misunderstanding.

MY COMMUNICATION STYLE (each person check):

- ☐ Assertive (direct, respectful, clear)
- ☐ Passive (avoid conflict, hold it in, hint)
- ☐ Aggressive (loud, critical, attacking)
- ☐ Passive-aggressive (sarcasm, silent treatment)

WHEN I'M UPSET, I TEND TO:

He: ☐ Withdraw ☐ Attack ☐ Shut down ☐ Cry

She: ☐ Withdraw ☐ Attack ☐ Shut down ☐ Cry

WHAT I NEED WHEN I'M UPSET:

He needs: _____

She needs: _____

CONVERSATION RULES WE AGREE TO:

1. No name-calling, ever
2. No bringing up the past (stay on topic)
3. Take a break if voices raise (return in ____ min)
4. Listen to understand, not to respond
5. Use 'I feel' instead of 'You always'
6. Pray before difficult conversations
7. _____

LOVE LANGUAGES DISCOVERY

The 5 Love Languages (Gary Chapman):

1. WORDS OF AFFIRMATION: Compliments, encouragement, verbal love
2. ACTS OF SERVICE: Doing helpful things (chores, errands, cooking)
3. RECEIVING GIFTS: Thoughtful presents, symbolic gestures
4. QUALITY TIME: Undivided attention, shared experiences
5. PHYSICAL TOUCH: Hugs, holding hands, intimacy, closeness

MY PRIMARY LOVE LANGUAGE: He: ____ She: ____

MY SECONDARY LOVE LANGUAGE: He: ____ She: ____

HOW TO FILL MY SPOUSE'S LOVE TANK:

If his language is _____, I will: _____

If her language is _____, I will: _____

THINGS THAT DRAIN MY LOVE TANK:

He: _____

She: _____

This week I will love my spouse in THEIR language by:

He will: _____

She will: _____

CONFLICT RESOLUTION GOD'S WAY

'Be quick to listen, slow to speak, slow to become angry.'

- James 1:19

BIBLICAL PRINCIPLES FOR CONFLICT:

1. PRAY FIRST (Matthew 18:19-20)

Before discussing, pray together for wisdom and humility.

2. SPEAK THE TRUTH IN LOVE (Ephesians 4:15)

Be honest but gentle. Seek to build up, not tear down.

3. DO NOT LET THE SUN GO DOWN ON YOUR ANGER (Eph 4:26)

Resolve issues the same day when possible.

4. SEEK TO UNDERSTAND (Proverbs 18:2)

A fool takes no pleasure in understanding. Listen first.

5. FORGIVE AS CHRIST FORGAVE YOU (Colossians 3:13)

Forgiveness is a choice, not a feeling. Choose it daily.

OUR CONFLICT PATTERN:

What we fight about most: _____

What triggers us: He: _____ She: _____

What we'll do differently: _____

FORGIVENESS EXERCISES FOR COUPLES

'Bear with each other and forgive one another if any of you has a grievance. Forgive as the Lord forgave you.' - Col 3:13

EXERCISE 1: Naming the Hurt

What my spouse did that hurt me:

How it made me feel: _____

What I need to hear from them: _____

EXERCISE 2: Taking Responsibility

My part in the conflict (be honest):

What I'm sorry for: _____

EXERCISE 3: Choosing Forgiveness

'I forgive you for _____.

I choose to release this and not hold it over you.

This does not mean it was okay, but I choose freedom.'

EXERCISE 4: Rebuilding Trust

Trust is rebuilt through consistent actions over time.

Action I commit to: _____

How my spouse can help: _____

We will check in on this: Weekly / Monthly

INTIMACY BUILDING ACTIVITIES

Intimacy = Into Me You See. It's more than physical.

EMOTIONAL INTIMACY BUILDERS:

- Share one thing you're grateful for about each other daily
- Ask 'How was your heart today?' instead of 'How was your day?'
- Share a childhood memory each week
- Dream together about the future
- Pray together before sleep

PHYSICAL INTIMACY BUILDERS:

- Hold hands during prayer
- 10-second kiss daily (yes, count!)
- Non-sexual touch: back rubs, foot massages
- Discuss needs and desires openly without shame

SPIRITUAL INTIMACY BUILDERS:

- Read Scripture together weekly
- Pray together daily (even if short)
- Attend church together
- Serve together in ministry
- Share what God is teaching you

This week we will intentionally connect by:

PRAYER TOGETHER GUIDE

'For where two or three gather in my name, there am I with them.'

- Matthew 18:20

Many couples struggle to pray together. Start simple:

BEGINNER: Sentence Prayers

Take turns saying one sentence each. That's enough.

INTERMEDIATE: ACTS Model

A - Adoration (praise God together)

C - Confession (not to each other - to God silently)

T - Thanksgiving (name 3 blessings together)

S - Supplication (pray for each other's needs)

ADVANCED: Praying Scripture Together

Choose a verse and pray it over your marriage:

PRAYER PROMPTS FOR COUPLES:

- Lord, help us to love each other as You love us.
- Give us patience when we frustrate each other.
- Protect our marriage from temptation and division.
- Help us to put each other before ourselves.
- Draw us closer to You and to each other.

We commit to praying together:

___ Daily ___ 3x/week ___ Weekly

Best time for us: _____

FINANCIAL UNITY WORKSHEET

Money conflict is the #1 cause of divorce. Get on the same page.

OUR FINANCIAL VALUES:

His top financial priority: _____

Her top financial priority: _____

Where we agree: _____

Where we disagree: _____

OUR FINANCIAL GOALS (together):

6-month goal: \$_____ For: _____

1-year goal: \$_____ For: _____

5-year goal: \$_____ For: _____

BUDGET AGREEMENTS:

Monthly income: \$_____

Giving/tithe (____%): \$_____

Savings (____%): \$_____

Spending money (each): \$_____

No-discussion spending limit: \$_____

Must-discuss spending limit: \$_____

DEBT PAYOFF PLAN:

Total debt: \$_____

Method: Snowball / Avalanche / Other

Target debt-free date: _____

PARENTING ALIGNMENT & DATE NIGHTS

PARENTING ALIGNMENT CHECK (if applicable):

Our parenting style: Authoritative / Permissive / Strict

His tendency: ____ Her tendency: ____

We agree on: _____

We disagree on: _____

How we'll handle disagreements about kids:

Rules: united front in public, discuss privately.

WEEKLY DATE NIGHT PLANNER:

Our date night: Every _____ at _____

Babysitter/childcare: _____

DATE IDEAS (alternate choosing):

1. _____ 2. _____

3. _____ 4. _____

5. _____ 6. _____

DATE NIGHT RULES:

- No phones (or limited use)
- No talking about kids/work only
- Take turns planning
- Budget: \$_____ per date

30-DAY GRATITUDE CHALLENGE FOR SPOUSE

Each day, write one thing you're grateful for about your spouse:

Day 1: _____

Day 2: _____

Day 3: _____

Day 4: _____

Day 5: _____

Day 6: _____

Day 7: _____

Day 8: _____

Day 9: _____

Day 10: _____

Day 11: _____

Day 12: _____

Day 13: _____

Day 14: _____

Day 15: _____

Day 16: _____

Day 17: _____

Day 18: _____

Day 19: _____

Day 20: _____

Day 21: _____

Day 22: _____

Day 23: _____

Day 24: _____

Day 25: _____

Day 26: _____

Day 27: _____

Day 28: _____

Day 29: _____

Day 30: _____

FIGHTING FAIR RULES AGREEMENT

We agree to the following rules when we disagree:

- ☐ We will not raise our voices
- ☐ We will not use words like 'always' or 'never'
- ☐ We will not bring up past forgiven offenses
- ☐ We will not involve children in our arguments
- ☐ We will not threaten divorce
- ☐ We will take a time-out if emotions escalate
- ☐ We will use I-statements
- ☐ We will listen without interrupting
- ☐ We will not go to bed without at least a truce
- ☐ We will pray together after resolution
- ☐ We will not discuss issues via text message
- ☐ We will not criticize in front of others

Our safe word for 'I need a break': _____

Break duration: _____ minutes

Who returns to the conversation first: _____

Signed: He: _____ She: _____

Date: _____

OUR SHARED VISION & GOALS

'Where there is no vision, the people perish.' - Proverbs 29:18

OUR FAMILY VISION STATEMENT:

1-YEAR GOALS (together):

Spiritual: _____

Financial: _____

Relational: _____

Fun/Adventure: _____

5-YEAR VISION:

Where we live: _____

Career: _____

Family: _____

Ministry: _____

10-YEAR DREAM:

OUR MARRIAGE MISSION:

As a couple, we exist to: _____

ANNIVERSARY REFLECTION - YEAR 1

Date: ____/____/____ (Anniversary #1)

HIGHLIGHTS OF THIS YEAR:

Best memory together: _____

Biggest challenge we overcame: _____

How we grew closer: _____

GRATITUDE:

He is grateful for: _____

She is grateful for: _____

AREAS FOR GROWTH NEXT YEAR:

We want to improve: _____

We commit to: _____

LOVE NOTE TO EACH OTHER:

His note: _____

Her note: _____

ANNIVERSARY REFLECTION - YEAR 2

Date: ____/____/____ (Anniversary #2)

HIGHLIGHTS OF THIS YEAR:

Best memory together: _____

Biggest challenge we overcame: _____

How we grew closer: _____

GRATITUDE:

He is grateful for: _____

She is grateful for: _____

AREAS FOR GROWTH NEXT YEAR:

We want to improve: _____

We commit to: _____

LOVE NOTE TO EACH OTHER:

His note: _____

Her note: _____

ANNIVERSARY REFLECTION - YEAR 3

Date: ____/____/____ (Anniversary #3)

HIGHLIGHTS OF THIS YEAR:

Best memory together: _____

Biggest challenge we overcame: _____

How we grew closer: _____

GRATITUDE:

He is grateful for: _____

She is grateful for: _____

AREAS FOR GROWTH NEXT YEAR:

We want to improve: _____

We commit to: _____

LOVE NOTE TO EACH OTHER:

His note: _____

Her note: _____

ANNIVERSARY REFLECTION - YEAR 4

Date: ____/____/____ (Anniversary #4)

HIGHLIGHTS OF THIS YEAR:

Best memory together: _____

Biggest challenge we overcame: _____

How we grew closer: _____

GRATITUDE:

He is grateful for: _____

She is grateful for: _____

AREAS FOR GROWTH NEXT YEAR:

We want to improve: _____

We commit to: _____

LOVE NOTE TO EACH OTHER:

His note: _____

Her note: _____

ANNIVERSARY REFLECTION - YEAR 5

Date: ____/____/____ (Anniversary #5)

HIGHLIGHTS OF THIS YEAR:

Best memory together: _____

Biggest challenge we overcame: _____

How we grew closer: _____

GRATITUDE:

He is grateful for: _____

She is grateful for: _____

AREAS FOR GROWTH NEXT YEAR:

We want to improve: _____

We commit to: _____

LOVE NOTE TO EACH OTHER:

His note: _____

Her note: _____

SCRIPTURE PROMISES FOR MARRIAGE

'Love is patient, love is kind. It does not envy, it does not boast.'

- 1 Corinthians 13:4

'Two are better than one, because they have a good return for their labor.' - Ecclesiastes 4:9

'Above all, love each other deeply, because love covers over a multitude of sins.' - 1 Peter 4:8

'Submit to one another out of reverence for Christ.'

- Ephesians 5:21

'Be completely humble and gentle; be patient, bearing with one another in love.' - Ephesians 4:2

'Therefore encourage one another and build each other up.'

- 1 Thessalonians 5:11

'Let all that you do be done in love.' - 1 Corinthians 16:14

OUR MARRIAGE VERSE:

Your marriage is worth fighting for. Keep choosing each other.